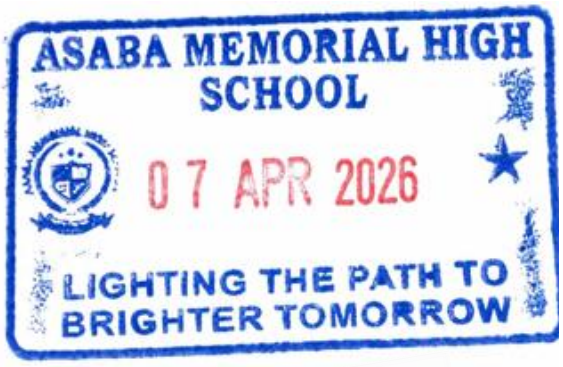


ASABA MEMORIAL HIGH SCHOOL

STAFF CODE OF CONDUCT

Policy reference	**AMHS/SCC/001/2026**
Version	**1.0**
Policy owner	**Asaba Memorial High School**
Responsible lead	**Headteacher**
Approval authority	**Board of Governors (BOG), subject to applicable law**
Approved by: **Byamungu Bienvenu, Chairperson BOG**	
Date Approved	**07th April 2026**
Effective date	**07th April 2026**
Review cycle	**At least every three years, or earlier if required**
Next review date	**07th April 2029**
Status	**APPROVED**

1. Introduction

Asaba Memorial High School recognises that the conduct of its staff plays an important role in the quality of education, discipline, safety and general development of learners.

Every staff member is expected to demonstrate professionalism, honesty, respect, responsibility and commitment to the school's mission. Staff members must act in a manner that protects the dignity and rights of learners, promotes a safe learning environment and maintains public confidence in the school.

This Code of Conduct establishes the standards of behaviour expected of everyone working at or representing AMHS.

2. Purpose of the Code

The purpose of this Code is to:

1. Establish clear standards of professional behaviour for all staff.
2. Protect learners from abuse, exploitation, neglect, harassment and other forms of harm.
3. Promote accountability, discipline and respect within the school.
4. Guide staff in their relationships with learners, parents, colleagues and the wider community.
5. Provide a basis for addressing misconduct and handling disciplinary matters fairly.
6. Promote a positive working environment that supports effective teaching and learning.

3. Scope of application

This Code applies to all persons working for, volunteering with or representing AMHS, regardless of their position or employment arrangement.

It covers:

- Teaching staff.
- Non-teaching and support staff.
- Administrative and management staff.
- The Headteacher and Deputy Headteacher.
- The School Director/Founder.

- Matrons, patrons, boarding supervisors and other learner-care personnel.
- Security personnel, drivers and other school workers.
- Volunteers, interns, consultants and contractors who interact with learners or work within the school.

Board of Governors members are also expected to uphold the principles of this Code when carrying out their responsibilities and interacting with learners and staff.

No person shall be exempt from safeguarding and professional conduct standards because of seniority, position, ownership, length of service or personal relationship with the school.

4. Guiding principles

All staff shall be guided by the following principles:

- Integrity: Be honest, trustworthy and transparent in all professional dealings.
- Respect: Treat learners, colleagues, parents and visitors with dignity, fairness and courtesy.
- Responsibility: Carry out assigned duties diligently and accept accountability for decisions and actions.
- Professionalism: Maintain appropriate conduct, appearance, communication and relationships.
- Child protection: Put the safety, welfare and best interests of learners first.
- Fairness: Avoid discrimination, favouritism and abuse of authority.
- Confidentiality: Protect personal, school and learner information.
- Accountability: Follow school policies, lawful instructions and established procedures.

5. Professional conduct and responsibilities

Every staff member shall:

1. Perform assigned duties honestly, diligently and to the best of their ability.
2. Observe working hours, school schedules and professional responsibilities.

3. Prepare adequately for lessons, meetings, duties and other assigned activities.
4. Follow approved school policies, procedures and administrative instructions.
5. Maintain a professional relationship with learners, parents, colleagues and visitors.
6. Communicate respectfully and avoid abusive, threatening or insulting language.
7. Cooperate with colleagues and school management in achieving the school's objectives.
8. Avoid conduct that may damage the reputation or interests of the school.
9. Report misconduct, safety concerns and suspected abuse through the appropriate channels.
10. Avoid using their position to obtain personal benefits or favours.

Staff shall not engage in activities that interfere with their responsibilities or compromise the quality of services provided to learners.

6. Child protection and safeguarding

AMHS is committed to providing a safe environment in which every learner is protected from abuse, neglect, exploitation, harassment and other forms of harm.

All staff members have a responsibility to safeguard learners.

Staff shall:

1. Treat every learner with dignity, patience and respect.
2. Protect learners from physical, emotional and sexual abuse.
3. Avoid actions, language or behaviour that may humiliate, intimidate or degrade learners.
4. Report suspected or disclosed cases of abuse, neglect, exploitation, bullying or other safeguarding concerns.
5. Avoid keeping secrets with learners about matters involving their safety or welfare.
6. Follow the school's Child Protection and Safeguarding Policy.
7. Cooperate with authorised investigations and safeguarding procedures.

8. Never discourage a learner from reporting abuse or seeking help.

A staff member who receives a disclosure of abuse shall listen calmly, take the learner seriously, avoid leading questions, refrain from promising absolute confidentiality and promptly report the matter to the designated safeguarding person.

Staff shall not investigate allegations of child abuse independently or confront an alleged offender in a way that may compromise the safety of the learner or an investigation.

7. Professional boundaries with learners

Staff members must maintain appropriate professional boundaries at all times.

The following conduct is prohibited:

1. Entering into romantic or sexual relationships with learners.
2. Engaging in sexual activity with any learner under 18 years.
3. Making sexual comments, jokes, gestures or suggestions towards learners.
4. Requesting or sharing sexually explicit images or messages with learners.
5. Touching learners inappropriately or unnecessarily.
6. Meeting learners secretly or arranging private encounters without a legitimate school-related reason and appropriate safeguards.
7. Giving special treatment to learners in exchange for gifts, money, favours or personal attention.
8. Using personal relationships to manipulate or exploit learners.
9. Communicating with learners through private channels in ways that violate school rules or bypass appropriate safeguards.

Any necessary one-to-one interaction with a learner should be conducted in a safe, observable and accountable environment, with appropriate authorisation where required.

8. Discipline and treatment of learners

AMHS promotes positive discipline that helps learners develop self-control, responsibility and respect for others.

Staff shall use appropriate, non-violent and constructive approaches to discipline.

The following practices are prohibited:

- Corporal punishment and physical punishment.
- Slapping, beating, kicking, shaking or any other physical assault.
- Humiliation, ridicule, threats or degrading treatment.
- Punishing learners through denial of food, water, medication or necessary toilet access.
- Collective punishment for offences committed by individual learners.
- Any disciplinary action that places a learner's physical or emotional wellbeing at risk.

Disciplinary concerns shall be handled in accordance with approved school rules and procedures. Serious or repeated cases must be referred to the appropriate school authority.

9. Equality, inclusion and non-discrimination

All learners and staff shall be treated fairly regardless of gender, disability, family background, social or economic status, nationality, religion or other personal circumstances.

Staff shall:

1. Promote equal opportunities for boys and girls.
2. Respect learners with disabilities and provide reasonable support within the school's capacity.
3. Avoid discriminatory language, actions or decisions.
4. Prevent and report bullying, sexual harassment and gender-based violence.
5. Ensure that learners are not denied opportunities because of personal prejudice or favouritism.
6. Promote a school environment where every learner feels safe, respected and included.

10. Attendance, punctuality and performance

Staff members are expected to be reliable and committed to their responsibilities.

Every staff member shall:

1. Report to work on time and observe the approved working schedule.

2. Attend lessons, meetings, assemblies and assigned duties punctually.
3. Obtain permission from the appropriate supervisor before leaving the school during working hours.
4. Follow the school's leave and absence procedures.
5. Inform the supervisor as early as reasonably possible when unable to report for duty.
6. Complete assigned work within agreed timelines.
7. Maintain appropriate records of work performed.
8. Participate in staff meetings, training and professional development activities.

Repeated lateness, unexplained absence, neglect of duty or failure to perform assigned responsibilities may result in disciplinary action.

11. Professional relationships and workplace behaviour

Staff shall maintain respectful and cooperative relationships with colleagues, learners, parents and visitors.

Staff must not:

- Engage in bullying, intimidation, harassment or workplace violence.
- Spread malicious rumours or deliberately undermine colleagues.
- Use abusive or threatening language.
- Engage in fights or other disorderly conduct within school premises.
- Disrupt school activities through personal disagreements.
- Abuse authority or intimidate junior staff.
- Encourage divisions, discrimination or hostility among staff members.

Disagreements should be addressed professionally through the established reporting and management structures.

12. Sexual harassment, exploitation and abuse of authority

AMHS does not tolerate sexual harassment, sexual exploitation or abuse of authority.

Staff members shall not use their position, influence or access to learners or colleagues to seek sexual favours, personal relationships, money or other benefits.

Prohibited conduct includes:

1. Unwanted sexual advances or requests for sexual favours.
2. Sexual comments, gestures or jokes that create an uncomfortable environment.
3. Offering employment benefits, marks, privileges or favourable treatment in exchange for sexual favours.
4. Threatening punishment or disadvantage for rejecting sexual advances.
5. Exploiting learners, colleagues or other persons who are in a position of vulnerability.

All allegations must be reported and handled in accordance with the school's safeguarding and disciplinary procedures.

13. Confidentiality and protection of information

Staff members may access confidential information relating to learners, parents, colleagues and the school.

Such information must be handled responsibly.

Staff shall:

1. Keep learner records, examination results, medical information and personal details confidential.
2. Share confidential information only with authorised persons for legitimate school purposes.
3. Protect school documents, registers, files and electronic records from unauthorised access.
4. Avoid discussing sensitive learner or staff matters in public places.
5. Avoid sharing photographs, videos or personal information of learners without proper authorisation.
6. Return school records and documents when requested or upon leaving employment.

Confidentiality must not be used as a reason to conceal abuse, exploitation, criminal conduct or serious safeguarding concerns.

14. Use of digital devices and social media

Staff members shall use digital platforms responsibly and protect the school's reputation and the privacy of learners.

Staff shall:

1. Use approved communication channels when communicating with learners and parents.
2. Maintain professional language and conduct in all digital communications.
3. Obtain appropriate permission before taking or sharing photographs or videos of learners.
4. Avoid posting identifiable learner information without authorisation.
5. Never request, create, store or distribute sexually explicit images involving learners.
6. Avoid inappropriate personal communication with learners through social media.
7. Protect passwords and school digital accounts.
8. Report cyberbullying, online harassment and inappropriate digital interactions involving learners.

Personal devices used for school activities must not compromise learner safety or confidentiality.

15. Gifts, financial integrity and conflicts of interest

Staff members must act honestly and avoid situations where personal interests conflict with their professional responsibilities.

Staff shall:

1. Avoid soliciting money, gifts or personal favours from learners or parents.
2. Not demand payment for services that are supposed to be provided by the school without authorisation.
3. Not use school funds or property for personal benefit.
4. Declare any actual or potential conflict of interest to the appropriate supervisor.
5. Avoid favouritism in admissions, assessment, procurement, recruitment and other school processes.
6. Ensure that all school transactions are properly authorised and documented.
7. Not falsify records, receipts, examination results, attendance registers or other school documents.

Any gifts offered to staff in connection with their official duties must be handled in accordance with the school's approved procedures.

16. Dress code and personal presentation

Staff members shall maintain a neat, decent and professional appearance appropriate to their duties and the school environment.

Clothing should be respectful, modest and suitable for interaction with learners.

Staff shall also observe appropriate personal hygiene and ensure that their appearance does not undermine the professional image of the school.

17. Health, safety and school property

Every staff member has a responsibility to maintain a safe and healthy school environment.

Staff shall:

1. Follow school health and safety procedures.
2. Report accidents, injuries, hazards and unsafe conditions immediately.
3. Keep classrooms, offices, dormitories and other assigned areas clean and safe.
4. Use school equipment and facilities responsibly.
5. Protect school property from loss, damage or misuse.
6. Avoid possessing or using illegal drugs or intoxicating substances while on duty or within school premises.
7. Never report for duty while impaired by alcohol or other intoxicating substances.
8. Follow emergency procedures, including fire safety and evacuation instructions.

School property must not be removed, transferred or used for private purposes without authorisation.

18. Reporting misconduct and safeguarding concerns

All staff members have a duty to report misconduct and concerns that may affect the safety, welfare or proper management of the school.

The following reporting channels shall apply:

- Ordinary workplace or professional misconduct: Report to the immediate supervisor or Headteacher.

- Child protection and safeguarding concerns: Report promptly to the designated Child Protection Focal Person or Headteacher.
- Where the Headteacher or Child Protection Focal Person is implicated: Report directly to the non-implicated Chairperson of the Board of Governors or another authorised, non-implicated Board member.
- Where the School Director/Founder or BOG Chairperson is implicated: Report through an independent, non-implicated Board channel or to the appropriate statutory authority.
- Immediate danger or suspected serious crime: Contact the relevant authorities, including the Police or appropriate child protection authorities, without waiting for internal approval.

Reports must be made honestly and in good faith. Staff members shall not retaliate against anyone who reports a concern or participates in an investigation.

19. Handling allegations and disciplinary matters

AMHS shall handle allegations of misconduct fairly, confidentially and without unnecessary delay.

The school shall:

1. Receive and document complaints or reports.
2. Assess immediate risks and take appropriate steps to protect affected persons.
3. Refer safeguarding concerns to the appropriate authorities where necessary.
4. Conduct a fair and impartial internal process where appropriate.
5. Give the person accused an opportunity to respond to the allegations.
6. Protect complainants, witnesses and affected learners from intimidation or retaliation.
7. Maintain appropriate records of the process and outcome.

Where necessary, a staff member may be temporarily reassigned or placed on precautionary suspension in accordance with applicable employment requirements while investigations are conducted. Such action shall not automatically be treated as proof of guilt.

Disciplinary measures shall be proportionate to the misconduct and consistent with applicable employment laws, school policies and fair procedures.

A staff member who is dissatisfied with a disciplinary decision may appeal through the appropriate school governance structure.

20. Responsibilities for implementation

Board of Governors

The Board shall:

- Provide oversight of the implementation of this Code.
- Ensure that complaints involving senior school officials are handled independently.
- Review serious disciplinary matters in accordance with its mandate.
- Review and approve any proposed amendments to this Code.

Chairperson of the Board of Governors – Byamungu Bienvenu

The Chairperson shall provide governance oversight and ensure that concerns involving the Headteacher or other senior officials are handled through an appropriate independent process, provided the Chairperson is not implicated.

School Director/Founder

The Director/Founder shall:

- Support the implementation of this Code.
- Respect the professional responsibilities of the Headteacher and other staff.
- Uphold the same standards of conduct expected of other school personnel.
- Avoid using the office of Director/Founder to interfere with fair disciplinary or safeguarding procedures.

Headteacher

The Headteacher shall:

- Communicate this Code to all staff.
- Ensure that staff understand and comply with its provisions.
- Coordinate staff induction and sensitisation.
- Supervise staff conduct and performance.
- Receive and address complaints within the scope of the office.

- Refer serious safeguarding and disciplinary matters to the appropriate authorities.

Child Protection Focal Person

The designated Focal Person shall:

- Receive and document safeguarding concerns.
- Support safe reporting and appropriate referrals.
- Maintain confidentiality and secure records.
- Advise school management on safeguarding responsibilities.
- Ensure that concerns are escalated where necessary.

All staff members

Every staff member shall:

- Read and understand this Code.
- Comply with its provisions.
- Attend required training and sensitisation.
- Report concerns through the appropriate channels.
- Sign the staff declaration confirming their commitment to the Code.

21. Induction, communication and review

Every new staff member shall receive a copy of this Code and an explanation of its requirements before or upon commencement of duties.

Existing staff shall be sensitised to the Code and required to sign the staff declaration.

The Headteacher shall ensure that the Code is accessible to staff and that any amendments are communicated appropriately.

This Code shall be reviewed at least once every two years or earlier where changes in the law, school operations or safeguarding requirements make a review necessary.

Any amendment shall be submitted to the Board of Governors for approval.

22. Approval and adoption

This Staff Code of Conduct has been reviewed and approved by the Board of Governors of Asaba Memorial High School. It shall guide the conduct and professional responsibilities of all persons covered under its scope.

The Code takes effect from the date of approval and remains in force until amended or replaced by the Board of Governors.

Annex A: Staff declaration and commitment

I confirm that I have received, read and understood the Asaba Memorial High School Staff Code of Conduct.

I understand that I am required to uphold the standards and responsibilities set out in this Code and that failure to comply may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the school's procedures and applicable laws.

I commit to protecting learners, respecting their rights and dignity, maintaining professional boundaries and reporting any conduct that may put learners or other members of the school community at risk.

I understand that this commitment applies throughout my service at Asaba Memorial High School.

Staff details

Full Name: _____

Position/Designation: _____

Department: _____

Employment Status: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____

Annex B: Staff induction checklist

The Headteacher or designated officer shall confirm that each staff member has:

- Received a copy of the Staff Code of Conduct.
- Been briefed on the Child Protection and Safeguarding Policy.
- Understood the rules on professional boundaries with learners.
- Understood the prohibition of corporal punishment.
- Been informed of the reporting channels.
- Understood confidentiality and responsible use of digital platforms.
- Been informed of disciplinary procedures.

- Signed the Staff Declaration and Commitment.